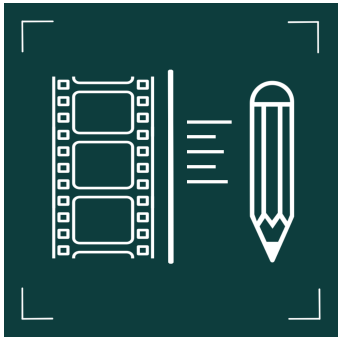
CINEside CONNECT

User Manual

Version 0.3 · macOS and iPad

Annotate and collaborate on CINEside projects.



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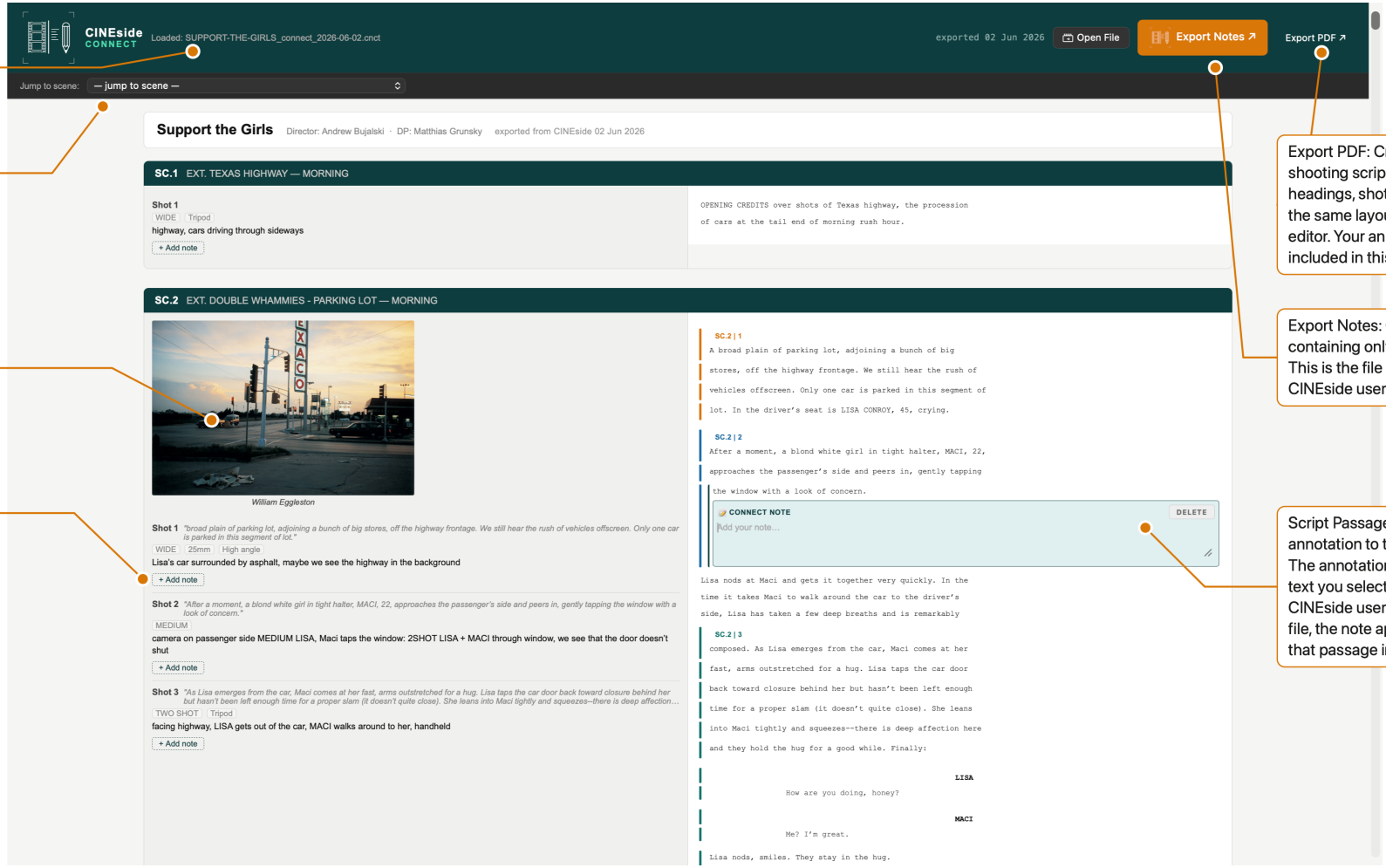
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Shows the filename of the open package.

Navigating Scenes: Open the scene dropdown to jump directly to any scene.

Image Notes: For each reference image (scene photo, sketch, lighting plan, floorplan) a note can be added. Click on an image to open the annotation window.

Shot Notes: Shot notes are the primary tool for shot-by-shot feedback — alternative framings, questions about focal lengths, comments on camera movement.



Export PDF: Creates a PDF of the shooting script — the scene headings, shot list, and screenplay in the same layout as the CINEside editor. Your annotations are not included in this PDF.

Export Notes: Creates a .cnsn file containing only your annotations. This is the file you send back to the CINEside user.

Script Passage Notes: ttach an annotation to that passage. The annotation is linked to the exact text you selected. When the CINEside user imports your .cnsn file, the note appears highlighted at that passage in their project.

1 Overview

1.1 What is CINEside CONNECT?

CINEside CONNECT is a free companion app for directors and collaborators. It opens .cnct packages exported from CINEside in read-only mode – the recipient can add annotations to shots, script passages, and reference images, but cannot edit the project itself. CINEside CONNECT is available for Mac and iPad. Both read the same .cnct packages and write the same .cnsn notes files, so packages and notes can be exchanged freely between the two.

CONNECT works completely offline. Nothing is uploaded or transmitted. All images are embedded in the package – no access to the original CINEside project folder is needed.
CONNECT is role-neutral. Both directions are possible: the cinematographer can send a package to the director for notes, or the director can send a package to the cinematographer. Any collaborator can use CONNECT regardless of their role in the project.

1.2 What CONNECT is not

CONNECT is not a full editing environment. Shots cannot be added, scene information cannot be changed, and project data cannot be modified. It is a focused annotation tool – designed for one clear purpose: structured feedback on a CINEside project.

> CINEside CONNECT handles the creative collaboration layer between cinematographer and director during prep.

1.3 File Formats

`.cnct` 	The CONNECT package. A self-contained file created by CINEside via CONNECT → Export ↗. Contains the complete shooting script, shot list, and all reference images. Read-only – open in CINEside CONNECT to annotate.
`.cnsn` 	The notes file you export after annotating. Contains your annotations together with the project structure they belong to – but no images, so it stays small. Send this back to the CINEside user for import.

Both file types are registered on Mac and iPad – double-clicking (or tapping) either one opens the correct application automatically..

2 Getting Started

2.1 Opening a Package

On the Mac, double-click a .cnct file, or launch CONNECT and click Open.
On the iPad, tap a .cnct file in Files, Mail, Messages or an AirDrop notification, or tap Open File… on the start screen.
The package is self-contained – all images are embedded. No internet connection is required while you work.

Recent files. The start screen lists the packages you opened before. Click an entry to open it again. If a file has been moved, renamed or deleted, CONNECT says so – the entry stays in the list and works again once the file is back, or use Locate… to open it from its new location.
On the iPad, CONNECT keeps its own copy of each package, so a recent entry works even if the original file has been moved.

New version of a project. When you open a package that replaces an earlier version at the same location, CONNECT offers to carry your existing notes over into the new version. Notes whose passage or image no longer exists in the new version are listed and left out. Either way, the earlier notes stay saved on your device.

2.2 Interface Layout

The layout mirrors CINEside: shots and notes on the left column, screenplay on the right. All fields are read-only – the only interactive elements are the note fields you add.

Toolbar (top)	Project title, scene navigation, export controls.
Scene navigation bar	Dropdown to move between scenes. The dropdown lists all scene headings for quick jumping.
Shots column (left)	All shots for the current scene, with their fields displayed read-only. Each shot has a note field at the bottom for your annotations.
Script column (right)	The screenplay text for the current scene. Select any passage to attach a note to it.
Window title bar	Shows the filename of the open package.
Shot numbers beside the script	Each shot anchored to a passage is drawn as a coloured line beside the script text, with its number at the top. Click or tap a number or a line to jump to that shot's card. Dashed sections mark passages that have been excluded from the shot ("not in frame").
Recent files	On the start screen: packages opened before, with a Clear recent files button.

2.3 Navigating Scenes

Open the scene dropdown to jump directly to any scene.
Visual references (reference photos, sketches, floorplans) are shown below the scene fields. Each image gets its own note field when clicked on.

3 Adding Notes

CINEside CONNECT offers three types of annotation, corresponding to the three kinds of content in a CINEside package.

3.1 Shot Notes

Every shot has a note button directly below its technical fields. Click or tap the button and type your annotation. There is no length limit.
Shot notes are the primary tool for shot-by-shot feedback – alternative framings, questions about focal lengths, comments on camera movement, intentions.

3.2 Script Passage Notes

Select any text in the script column to attach an annotation to that passage.
The annotation is linked to the exact text you selected. When the CINEside user imports your .cnsn file, the note appears highlighted at that passage in their project.

> Script passage notes are especially useful for flagging specific lines of dialogue or action beats that require a particular visual approach – marking the exact moment rather than leaving a general scene note.

3.3 Image Notes

For each reference image (scene photo, sketch, floorplan) a note can be added. Click or tap on an image to open the annotation window.
Image notes travel back with the .cnsn file and appear in CINEside attached to the corresponding image.

Shot note	Attached to a specific shot. Visible in the shot list in CINEside after import.
Script passage note	Linked to a selected text passage. Highlighted in the script after import.
Image note	Attached to a reference photo, sketch, or floorplan image.

3.4 How your notes are stored

CONNECT saves your notes on this device as you type – there is no Save command. The original .cnct package is never modified. Notes are kept per package and per version, so reopening the same file later brings them back.

“Unsaved” in CONNECT means something different: notes that have not yet been exported as a .cnsn file. Exporting is the only way your notes reach the CINEside user. If you close the window, quit, or open another package while notes have not been exported, CONNECT asks:

Cancel – Stay in the project.
Close without exporting (or Open without exporting) – Continue; the notes stay saved on this device.
Export notes & close – Export the .cnsn file first, then continue.

4 Exporting

When you have finished annotating, CINEside CONNECT offers two export options. On the Mac, Export Notes opens a chooser with the destination and Export PDF a save dialog.
On the iPad, both open the share sheet – AirDrop the file to a Mac, send it by Mail or Messages, or save it to Files.

4.1 Export Notes (.cnsn)

Save the .cnsn to disk, or share it directly – by AirDrop, Mail, Messages or any other share destination.

Save as...	Choose a location on disk.
Share...	AirDrop, Mail, Messages and other share destinations.

4.2 Export PDF

Creates a PDF of the shooting script – the scene headings, shot list, and screenplay with each shot drawn as a coloured line beside the script, as in CINEside.
Your annotations are not included in this PDF.
This export is useful when a collaborator needs a printed or distributable version of the current shooting script without access to CINEside.
The PDF embeds photos at 150 dpi and floor plans at 200 dpi – good for laser printing and on-screen viewing. On the Mac the PDF opens in Preview after the export.

Export Notes	A .cnsn file with all your annotations. Send this back to the CINEside user for import. This is the main collaboration output.
Export PDF	A PDF of the shooting script for printing or distribution. Does not include your annotations.

> You can export a .cnsn file multiple times during a session – for example to send partial feedback. Each export captures all annotations added so far. The CINEside user can import multiple .cnsn files; each import adds the new annotations without removing previous ones.

5 The Full Workflow

CONNECT supports two directions of collaboration. Both follow the same pattern: one person exports a package, the other annotates and returns a notes file.

5.1 Cinematographer sends to Director

Export package: In CINEside, click CONNECT → Export ↗ in the toolbar. CINEside creates a .cnct package with the shot list, script, and all reference images embedded.

Send the file: Send the .cnct file by email or file transfer. The recipient does not need a CINEside license – only the free CINEside CONNECT app.

Director annotates: The director opens the file in CINEside CONNECT, adds notes to shots, script passages, and images, then exports a .cnsn file and sends it back.

Import notes: The cinematographer double-clicks the .cnsn file. The annotations appear highlighted in the CINEside project.

5.2 Director sends to Cinematographer

The procedure is identical in reverse. The director exports a .cnct package from their CINEside project (Director mode) and sends it to the cinematographer, who annotates in CONNECT and returns a .cnsn file.

5.3 Importing Notes in CINEside

In CINEside, import a .cnsn file by double-clicking it, or via CONNECT → Import Notes in the toolbar.
All annotations appear highlighted in the project – on shots, script passages, and images. A green floating Next Note button appears at the bottom right of the window.

N / P	Navigate to the next or previous unreviewed note (keyboard shortcut).
✓ (checkmark)	Mark a note as reviewed. It remains visible but is no longer counted as pending.
→ Note	Copy the annotation into a permanent scene note in CINEside. This is how you integrate a collaborator's feedback into your project data.
✕	Delete the annotation.

CONNECT Notes are not included in any CINEside export unless you copy them to a scene note using the → Note button.

6 Limitations

CINEside CONNECT is intentionally focused. The following operations are not available:

Adding shots	The shot list is read-only. New shots can only be created in CINEside.
Editing scene data	Scene headers, technical fields, and all project metadata are read-only.
Adding or removing images	Reference photos, sketches, and floorplans cannot be added or removed in CONNECT.
Cloud sync	CONNECT works entirely offline. No data is transmitted or stored remotely.

7 Support

Questions, feedback, and bug reports: info@cineside.app
Every message is read personally.

Website: cineside.app
Getting Started guide: cineside.app/getting-started.html
CINEside CONNECT on the App Store (Mac + iPad): apps.apple.com/app/cineside-connect/id6793694166
CINEside on the App Store (Mac + iPad): apps.apple.com/app/cineside-shot-list-script/id6791491272

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